Game Pitch Proposal: Dahdi (Traditional Indian Mills Board Game)

Academic Game Development Project
Digital Traditional Strategy Game

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1. Cover Page

- Title of Project: Dahdi: Traditional Indian Mills Board Game
- Project Type: Digital Preservation & Casual Strategy Board Game
- Development Team: Student Game Development Project
- Lead Developer: Soumya Ranjan Samal
- Target Platforms: Modern Web Browser / HTML5 / CSS3 / JavaScript
- Date: September 2026

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2. Executive Summary

Dahdi brings a traditional Indian mills-style strategy game into a modern browser experience. The core game uses a 24-point board and nine pieces for each side. Players alternate between placing pieces, moving them and, when reduced to three pieces, flying them to any empty point. The central strategic objective is to create mills of three pieces and use them to capture the opponent.

The digital version adds a computer opponent with Easy, Medium and Master difficulty levels, a two-player Pass & Play mode, an optional diagonal board configuration, Hint and Undo functions, a Rules screen, audio and accessibility settings, and English, Hindi and Odia language options.

3. Game Description

a. Overview

Dahdi is a turn-based 2D strategy game for two sides. Each side has nine pieces and competes on a 24-point board. The game rewards planning rather than fast reflexes.

b. The Quest

The main quest is to outmaneuver the opponent by forming mills, capturing pieces, protecting your own formations and eventually reducing the opponent below three pieces or preventing all legal movement.

c. Main Character (The Player)

There is no narrative hero. The player's identity is represented through the Peacock side and the active player status card. The second side is represented by Haldi.

d. Sketch of Main Character / Token Layout

Insert a screenshot of the Peacock token and Player 1 status card from the game here.

e. Opponents (AI System)

The single-player opponent is the Haldi side controlled by the AI. Easy provides a casual challenge, Medium uses depth-3 search, and Master uses deeper search and caching.

f. Sketch of Opponent Architecture

Start Game → Determine Phase → Generate Legal Moves → Evaluate Candidate Moves → Search / Score Position → Select Move → Apply Move → Render Result.

g. Environment

The environment is a 2D traditional-inspired board with three concentric squares and 24 playable points. The interface uses a warm board-game presentation rather than a 3D world.

h. Sketch of Game Arena / World

Insert a screenshot of the complete 24-point Dahdi board here.

i. Menus

The interface includes game-mode selection, AI difficulty, diagonal-board option, language selection, audio controls, colour-blind mode, reduced motion, Rules, Settings, Undo, Hint, Restart and Rematch.

j. Controls & Ergonomics

Players select board points with mouse/touch interaction. Keyboard shortcuts include U for Undo, H for Hint, R for Rematch and Esc for Settings.

k. Sounds & Acoustic Identity

The game uses soft UI/gameplay feedback sounds and an optional Indian Tanpura drone. SFX and music volume can be controlled independently.

4. Strategic Experience

Dahdi is designed around readable decisions. Every turn asks the player to balance immediate opportunities against future board control. Forming a mill may provide a capture, but moving a piece can also open or close a future route. When a player reaches three pieces, the Flying phase changes the tactical possibilities because any empty point can become a destination.

5. Audience

- Students learning traditional games or game-development concepts.
- Casual players looking for a short strategy match.
- Families and friends using local Pass & Play.
- Players interested in Indian-inspired digital board games.

6. Accessibility & Localization

- English, Hindi and Odia interface text.
- Colour-blind mode.
- Reduced-motion option.
- Visible legal move indicators.
- Rules/help screen for first-time players.

7. Technical Pitch

- Frontend: HTML5 and CSS3.
- Logic: JavaScript ES modules.
- Rules: Centralized legal-move, mill, capture and win logic.
- AI: Easy, Medium and Master search with evaluation and caching.
- Rendering: 2D board and token rendering with legal-move feedback.
- Audio: Web Audio API.
- Persistence: Browser localStorage for selected preferences.

8. Why This Project Works as a College Game

The project demonstrates multiple software and game-development concepts in one manageable application: state management, rule modeling, search algorithms, UI interaction, accessibility, localization, audio programming and software modularity. The board-game scope keeps the project testable while still providing meaningful strategic depth.

9. Summary & Sales Pitch

Dahdi is a simple-to-access but strategically deep digital board game. Its identity comes from combining a traditional Indian mills-style rule set with a clean modern interface, a computer opponent, local two-player play and accessibility features. Because it runs in a browser, the game can be demonstrated easily in a classroom, lab or personal computer without requiring a large installation.

10. Demonstration Flow

- Open the game in a modern browser.
- Choose Player vs AI or 2-Player Pass & Play.
- Select AI difficulty if required.
- Place pieces and demonstrate a mill.
- Show the capture interaction.
- Move pieces during the Movement phase.
- Demonstrate Flying when a side has exactly three pieces.
- Open Settings and demonstrate language/accessibility options.
- Use Undo, Hint and Rematch.

11. Closing Statement

Dahdi is intended to show how a traditional strategic activity can be preserved through a lightweight digital implementation. The project balances authenticity of the core rules with practical modern features that make the game easy to demonstrate, understand and replay.